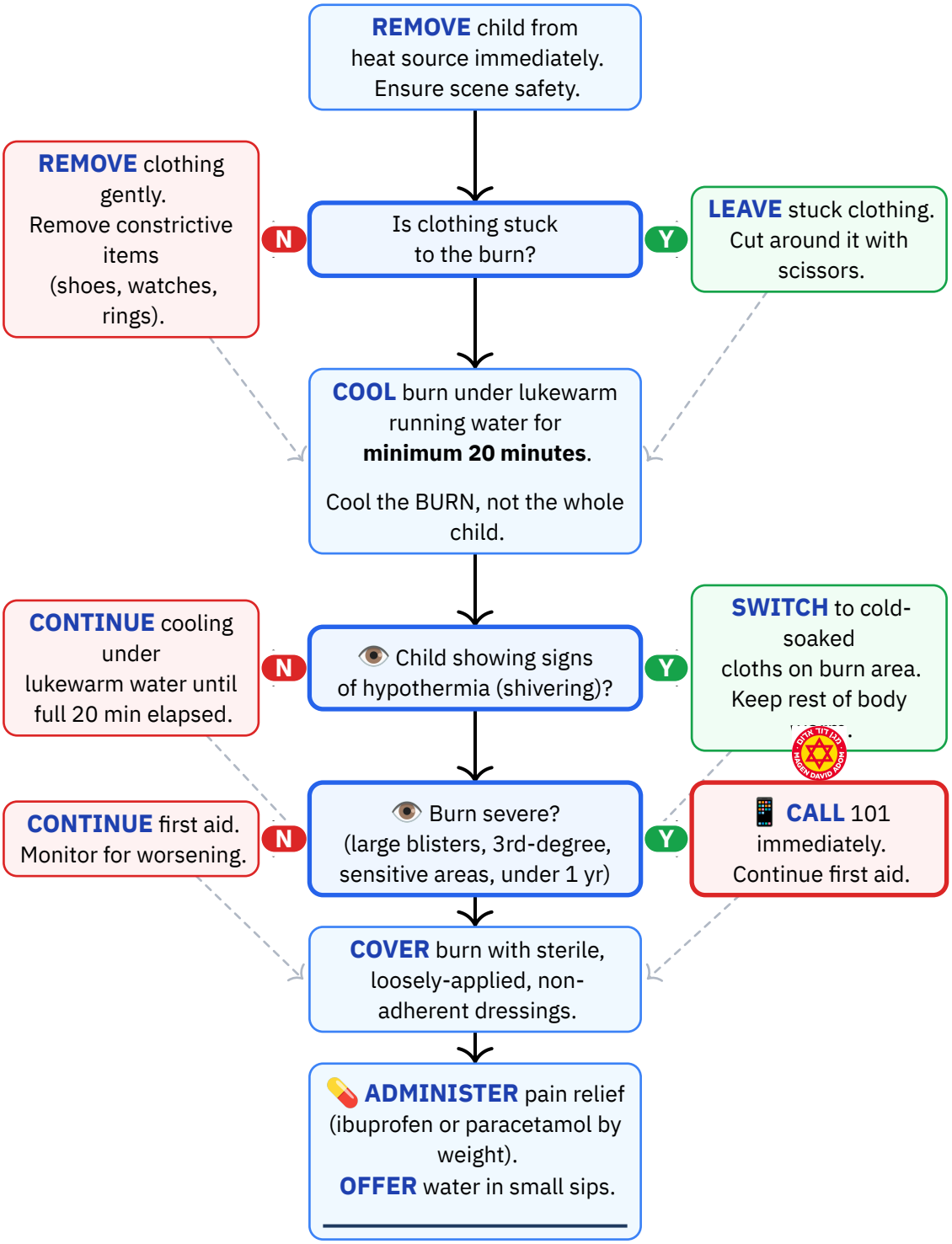

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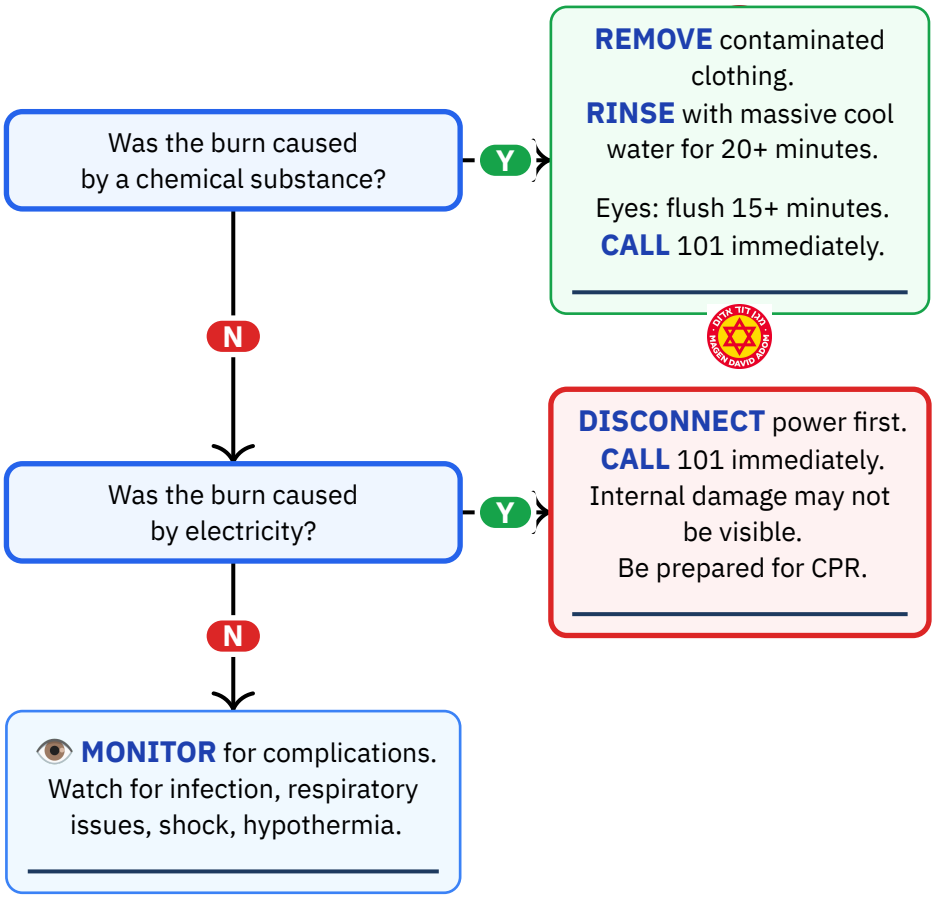
Chemical & Electrical Burns



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Reference Notes

DO NOT:

✕ **Do NOT apply ice or ice-cold water** – extreme cold causes additional tissue and blood vessel damage.
✕ **Do NOT apply toothpaste, coffee grounds, raw eggs, yogurt, or butter** – these create a heat-trapping layer and increase infection risk.
✕ **Do NOT puncture or pop blisters** – the fluid protects tissue during healing.
✕ **Do NOT apply ointments, oils, or powders** to serious burns before medical evaluation.
✕ **Do NOT use gauze pads or cotton wool directly on burns** – fibres adhere to damaged skin.
✕ **Do NOT remove clothing stuck to the burn** – cut around it instead.
✕ **Do NOT immerse the whole child in cold water** – cool the burn, not the child. High hypothermia risk.
✕ **Do NOT attempt chemical neutralisation** on chemical burns.
✕ **Do NOT leave the child unattended if unconscious** – call 101 immediately.

Equipment needed:

— Cool (lukewarm) running water source
— Sterile non-adherent dressings or clean dry sheet
— Scissors (to cut clothing around stuck areas)
— Blanket or towel (warmth during burn cooling)
— Age-appropriate pain relief (ibuprofen or paracetamol, dosed by weight)
— Drinking water (for hydration)

Hebrew Terminology — מונחים בעברית

English	עברית	Pronunciation
Burn	כוויה	kvi-YA
Scald	כוויה מנוזל חם	kvi-YA mi-no-ZEL kham
Cool water	מים פושרים	MA-yim posh-RIM
Blister	שלפוחית	shal-pu-KHIT
Bandage / dressing	תחבושת	takh-BO-shet
Pain	כאב	ke-EV
Child	ילד / ילדה	YE-led / yal-DA
Infant	תינוק / תינוקת	ti-NOK / ti-NO-ket
Ambulance	אמבולנס	am-bu-LANS
Emergency	חירום	khe-RUM
It hurts	כואב	ko-EV

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Source: Magen David Adom (MDA) – Burns First Aid Guidelines
URL: https://www.mdais.org/101/burns
Publication date: 2026-01-01
Imported: 2026-03-15 · **Last verified:** 2026-03-16
Key child difference: Minimum 20 minutes cooling (vs 10 for adults). Cool the burn, not the whole child. All burns in infants under 1 year require immediate medical attention.